SAGARMANTHAN

THE GLOBAL CONFLUENCE OF MARITIME VISIONARIES

"As we strive to realise the vision of a Viksit Bharat by 2047, dialogues such as Sagarmanthan are invaluable to build consensus, partnerships for a prosperous future": PM **Narendra Modi**

Sagarmanthan – The Great Oceans Dialogue, an initiative by the Ministry of Ports, Shipping & Waterways (MoPSW), has emerged as South Asia's largest maritime thought leadership forum. With 61 countries represented and a total of 1,773 registrations, the event brought together 215 international delegates and an audience of over 1,500 participants across 1.5 days.

India's maritime sector serves as the backbone of its trade and commerce, handling around 95% of the country's trade by volume and 70% by value. Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways (MoPSW) under the visionary leadership of Hon'ble PM, Sh. Narendra Modi and spearheaded by Hon'ble Union Minister- Ports, Shipping and Waterways, Sh. Sarbananda Sonowal organized Sagarmanthan- The Great Oceans Dialogue in partnership with Observer Research Foundation (ORF) between 18th- 19th November 2024, in New Delhi. The event witnessed a distinguished gathering of global leaders, policymakers, and industry experts, including Carl Bildt, Former Prime Minister of Sweden, Sanjeev Sanyal, member, EAC-PM, senior representatives from key port authorities like the Port of Antwerp-Bruges in Belgium, Port of Esbjerg in Denmark, and Suez Canal Authority in Egypt, alongside executives from private sector giants such as DP World and Naggar Shipping.

Participants also included thought leaders from premier think tanks like the World Maritime University in Germany and the Brookings Institution in the USA, as well as government and academic representatives from the Global South, including Kenya, Philippines, and Ethiopia, and small island nations like Seychelles and Papua New Guinea. With themes spanning the blue economy, global supply chains, and sustainable growth, Sagarmanthan set a bold course toward a vibrant, future-ready maritime ecosystem.

In his message sent from Camp Office in Nigeria, the PM Modi shared, "Our vision for a free, open and secure maritime network – be it the Indian Ocean or the Indo Pacific region - is finding resonance across the world. This dialogue on oceans further strengthen the rules-based world order and enhance peace, trust and friendship between nations.

In his address, Sh. Sarbananda Sonowal mentioned: "The Maritime India Vision 2030 and Maritime Amrit Kaal Vision 2047, envisioned by the Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways, aim to propel India's maritime sector into a global leadership position. Key targets include boosting ports cargo handling capacity from the current 2,690 MMTPA to ~3,500 MMTPA by 2030 and an ambitious ~10,000 MMTPA by 2047. The number of deep draft mega major ports is set to grow from 1 today to 7 by 2030 and 13 by 2047, with an integrated focus on creating 14 Green Hydrogen Hubs by 2047."



The inspiring Ministerial Interaction with Youth underscored the importance of nurturing the next generation of leaders, while discussions on energy transitions and new routes for critical minerals highlighted the sector's pivotal role in shaping a sustainable future.

Sh. Shantanu Thakur, Hon'ble Minister of State- PSW mentioned: "Public-Private Partnership (PPP) models will play a critical role, with the percentage of major port cargo handled by PPP increasing from 60% currently to 80% by 2030 and 90% by 2047. The vision also outlines ambitious growth in cruise tourism, projecting passenger numbers to rise from 5 lakh currently to 10 lakh by 2030 and a remarkable 50 lakh by 2047."

Sh. T.K. Ramachandran, Secretary-MoPSW reiterated that "In shipbuilding, India aims to enhance its global rank from 17 to 10 by 2030 and 5 by 2047, positioning itself as a major hub for maritime manufacturing. To facilitate this, the government is actively working towards creating a conducive policy ecosystem through proposed initiatives such as Maritime Development Fund (MDF) and Shipbuilding Financial Assistance Policy 2.0 "

Over two days, the event showcased a rich tapestry of ministerial bilateral meetings, intellectual roundtables, and diverse topical sessions. From exploring international corridors and climate resilience for coastal communities to examining AI-driven innovations in shipping and blue-green strategies for integrated resilience, the Role of European Investment in Asia and Africa, the dialogue provided a platform for collaborative action. Sagarmanthan's outcomes will undoubtedly serve as a cornerstone for building a future-ready, resilient, and inclusive maritime ecosystem.